

ALEX BAKER | JOHN PATTERSON

Level, Then Lost By Six

A career-best card from Alex Baker briefly squared the TEG 9 Trophy race before four calamitous holes handed it straight back to John Patterson.

Alex Baker's final round at Praia D'El Rey passed through every available emotion, mostly in the wrong order. The front nine opened a wound early. A triple bogey at the 4th, a quadruple bogey at the 6th, and bogeys at the 5th and 7th packed neatly around them. A birdie at the 8th stopped the bleeding, if not the memory of it.

The repair job held. It held long enough that a double bogey at the 14th drew him level at the top of the TEG 9 Trophy. Level was as far as he got. From the 14th to the 17th he shed

11 shots, including a second quadruple bogey at the 15th, one of the hardest holes on the course, and a double bogey at the index-one 17th. He gave the impression throughout of a man reading a weather forecast for somewhere else.

And yet the round was a personal best twice over: 44 Stableford points and a gross 27 over par. It is a peculiar kind of triumph, and it counts all the same. John Patterson ended the day out in front for the Trophy, the gap now six. David Mullin remained ahead for the TEG 9 Green Jacket.

AT A GLANCE
TROPHY WINNER John Patterson
GREEN JACKET David Mullin
WOODEN SPOON Stuart Neumann

ROUND STABLEFORD
JP 47 | AB 44 | DM 38 | GW 38 | SN 37 | JB 36
ROUND GROSS
DM +16 | JP +17 | JB +19 | SN +25 | AB +27 | GW +27

AFTER R4 • TROPHY
JP 168 | AB 162 | DM 148 | JB 146 | GW 143 | SN 127
AFTER R4 • GREEN JACKET
DM +67 | JB +77 | JP +88 | GW +115 | SN +125 | AB +127

JOHN PATTERSON

Patterson's Final-Round Redemption

Three days after a wobble dropped him into the bottom half of the field, John Patterson produced the best round of the week when it mattered most.

John Patterson signed for 47 Stableford points at Praia D'El Rey, the best round of the final day and 13 better than his third-round 34. He managed it while carrying a quintuple-bogey 9 at the 5th, one of the hardest holes on the course. Most cards do not survive a 9. His barely broke stride. He

assembled two stretches without dropping a gross shot, at the 6th and 7th and again at the 12th and 13th, the second of those including a birdie at the par-5 12th.

The round extended his overall lead in the TEG Trophy from 3 to 6. He held the lead before it and

he held the lead after it. Elsewhere in the same round, Gregg Williams took a sextuple-bogey 11 at the 7th, his worst hole of the tournament. The course had lost none of its appetite. It was simply being selective.

WOODEN SPOON

Neumann's Rally Comes Too Late

A blistering five-hole stretch in the middle of the round threatened an escape from the bottom of the TEG 9 standings, but the closing holes made sure of the Wooden Spoon regardless.

Stuart Neumann's final round was a fair summary of his entire TEG 9. Real quality, sealed at both ends by the golf that won him the TEG 9 Wooden Spoon. He opened by bleeding nine shots across holes 2 to 5, including a triple bogey at the 3rd. The 3rd is stroke index 18. It is the hole the course provides as a courtesy. He then went three consecutive holes without a net par.

The middle told an entirely different story. A birdie at the 13th launched a run of 16 points from the 11th to the 15th, with four holes from the 11th to the 14th passing without a single gross shot dropped. It was his best golf of the tournament. He appeared to have no idea what to do with it.

The 16th resolved the matter, a quadruple bogey on one of the harder holes on the course. He bled eight shots over the closing three, finishing double bogey, double bogey, quadruple bogey. The Wooden Spoon gap to the man above him widened to 16. At no point in the four days had he threatened to escape last place.

GREEN JACKET

Mullin Never Bettered In Any Round

David Mullin's final-round 16-over capped a Green Jacket campaign in which he posted the best or tied-best gross score in every round of the week.

David Mullin won the TEG 9 Green Jacket from the front, wire to wire, and sealed it with the best gross round of the day at Praia D'El Rey. The opening did not advertise the fact. He took a quadruple bogey 8 at the 1st, which is one way of introducing yourself to a golf course.

Then came order. Three straight pars from the 2nd through the 4th. A double bogey at the 5th, one of the hardest holes out there, ended that sequence. He simply began another: bogey-free from the 7th through the 9th, nine Stableford points gathered along the way, no visible fuss at any stage.

It was the strongest gross score in the field for the round. It capped a Jacket race he had led throughout, and he used the day to stretch seven strokes into ten. Patterson, meanwhile, held his own lead in the TEG 9 Trophy, though his cushion had shrunk to nothing by the finish.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 9, Round 4

PERSONAL BESTS

- Alex Baker posts a personal-best round: 44 pts
- Alex Baker posts a personal-best Gross round: +27

RARE FEATS

- Gregg Williams runs up an 11 (+6) at the 7th — his career-worst on a par-5